EXASTORE
AI MACHINES. DEVELOPERS. CREATORS. EVERYONE.

BUYING GUIDE
Version 1.0 | March 2026

AI PC Buying Guide

Find the Right Machine for Your AI Journey

Laptops, Workstations and Desktops for AI, ML, Development and Creation



AI-Ready Machines | Laptops, Desktops and Workstations | Comparison and Recommendations | For Developers, Creators and AI Builders

1. Choose the Right Machine for Your Needs

Use Case	Recommended Type	Key Requirements	Example Brands
.NET Development & General Productivity	Mainstream Laptop	16 GB RAM, SSD	Dell, Lenovo, HP, ASUS, Acer
Docker & Kubernetes Development	Performance Laptop	32 GB RAM, SSD, Multi-core CPU	Dell, Lenovo, ASUS, Microsoft
Local LLM Inference (7B–14B models)	AI Laptop or Mini PC	32–64 GB RAM, 8–16 GB VRAM	Nexa, ASUS, Lenovo, MSI, Acer
Model Training / Fine-tuning	Workstation / Desktop	64 GB+ RAM, 24 GB+ VRAM	Nexa, Dell, HP, Lenovo
Content Creation (Video/3D/Design)	Creator Laptop	32 GB RAM, 8–16 GB VRAM	ASUS, MSI, Dell, Apple
Portability with AI	AI PC (NPU + GPU)	Modern CPU, NPU, 32 GB RAM	Microsoft, Dell, Lenovo, ASUS

2. Key Buying Considerations

Processor
Intel Core Ultra, AMD Ryzen AI or Apple M-series

GPU
NVIDIA RTX or AMD Radeon for AI/ML workloads

Memory
16 GB minimum, 32–64 GB for AI development

Storage
1 TB NVMe SSD recommended

NPU
Useful for AI features and better battery life

3. Popular AI Machine Categories

AI Laptops

Portable and powerful for AI development

AI Workstations

Maximum performance for local AI and ML

AI Mini PCs

Compact and efficient for local inference

Copilot+ PCs

AI-powered with NPU for productivity

1. Start With the Workload

An 'AI PC' is not one fixed configuration. The right machine depends on whether AI runs mainly in the cloud, on an NPU, on a discrete GPU, or through a mixture of local and remote services. Begin with workload, portability and budget before comparing processor names.

Primary need	Recommended class	Key considerations
.NET / cloud AI development	Developer laptop	16-32 GB RAM, fast SSD, strong CPU, good battery; discrete GPU optional.
Docker + Kubernetes + AI development	Performance laptop / desktop	32-64 GB RAM, multi-core CPU, 1-2 TB SSD; GPU based on local-model needs.
Local LLM inference	AI laptop / mini workstation	32-64+ GB RAM and sufficient GPU VRAM; model size, precision and context matter.
Computer vision / deep learning	AI laptop / workstation	Discrete GPU, adequate VRAM, sustained cooling and fast storage.
Heavy local AI experimentation	AI workstation	64-128+ GB RAM, high-VRAM GPU, expandable storage and strong cooling.
AI productivity / mobility	NPU-focused AI PC	Efficient CPU/NPU, long battery life and supported on-device AI software.

2. Understand the Hardware

Component	Why it matters for AI
CPU	Runs application logic, preprocessing, development tools, databases and CPU-based inference.
GPU	Critical for many local LLM, computer-vision and deep-learning workloads. VRAM is often more important than gaming-oriented marketing labels.
NPU	Efficient accelerator for supported on-device AI workloads; it does not automatically replace a discrete GPU for every AI task.
System memory	Needed by IDEs, containers, vector databases, model runtimes and models that spill beyond GPU memory.
Storage	Models, containers, datasets and indexes can consume hundreds of gigabytes; NVMe storage is strongly preferred.
Cooling / power	Sustained AI workloads may run much longer than short benchmark bursts.

3. Memory & VRAM Planning

Profile	System RAM	GPU VRAM	Typical scenario
Cloud-first developer	16-32 GB	Optional	API-based AI apps, normal development
AI application developer	32-64 GB	8-12 GB	RAG, embeddings, small local models, CV prototyping
Advanced local AI	64 GB+	16-24 GB	Larger local inference and heavier GPU experimentation
AI workstation user	128 GB+	24 GB+	Large local experiments, multi-service AI labs and professional workloads

4. Machine Categories

Category	Best for	Trade-off
Developer laptop	Mobility, coding, cloud AI, containers	Less sustained GPU performance
AI laptop	Mobile local AI and GPU development	Higher weight, heat and cost
AI mini workstation	Compact local lab and always-on development	Limited expansion and GPU ceiling
Tower AI workstation	Maximum GPU, RAM and expansion	Not portable; higher power and cost
NPU-first AI PC	Battery-efficient supported on-device AI	NPU software support varies by workload

5. How NexaStore Recommendations Should Work

A recommendation should combine structured commerce data with technical knowledge. Price, inventory, exact RAM, exact GPU and current availability should come from the live catalog or commerce APIs. Explanations such as why VRAM matters, when an NPU is useful, or what hardware profile suits local LLMs can come from this knowledge guide and related RAG documents.

Question	Best source
What is the current price?	Commerce database / product API
Is the product in stock?	Inventory service
Does this SKU have 64 GB RAM?	Structured product catalog
Why would I need 16 GB VRAM?	RAG knowledge base
Which machine suits local LLM development?	Agent reasoning using product tools + RAG
Can I return it after purchase?	Return policy RAG + order data tool

6. Example Buying Profiles

Profile	Suggested direction
Cloud-focused .NET engineer	Developer laptop with 32 GB RAM, fast SSD and strong battery life.
RAG / agent developer	32-64 GB RAM; discrete GPU optional but useful for local embeddings and inference.
Local LLM enthusiast	Prioritize GPU VRAM and system RAM before display or ultra-thin design.
AI researcher / creator	AI laptop or tower workstation with high-VRAM GPU and sustained cooling.
Home AI lab	Mini workstation for compact workloads or tower workstation for maximum expansion.

Educational notice

This guide is part of the fictional NexaStore course environment. Brand examples and machine categories are educational; live product specifications and pricing should always come from the commerce catalog.